

SEO Account Manager Job Description

Role Overview

The SEO Account Manager is a trusted advisor and strategic partner to their clients. They drive measurable growth through strong SEO strategy, clear communication, and a focus on business outcomes.

This role requires both technical expertise and strategic thinking. Account Managers plan and lead all SEO work, including AI-generated content creation and optimization, E-E-A-T review, technical audits, and conversion improvements. They manage their accounts with independence, taking full ownership of strategy, execution, and performance outcomes.

Collaboration with other teams happens when it supports growth. AMs may work with PPC, Sales, or Admissions Ops on cross-sell opportunities and with the Dev team on large site or redesign projects. Day to day, they lead strategy, make data-driven decisions, and ensure all client work ties back to visibility, lead quality, and conversions.

Success in this role means delivering consistent performance against KPIs, earning client trust, and communicating insights that show the clear business impact of SEO.

Core Responsibilities

1. Strategic SEO Ownership

- Owns end-to-end SEO strategy and performance outcomes for assigned clients.
 - Conducts full audits (technical, content, authority) and translates findings into prioritized, actionable roadmaps.
 - Aligns strategies with client business goals (e.g., conversions, patient acquisition, lead quality).
 - Adapts to Google algorithm changes, AI-driven search evolution, and shifting user behavior.
 - Ensures all recommendations are data-backed, documented, and tied to measurable impact.
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2. Performance Management & Insights

- Tracks traffic, keyword visibility, conversions, and engagement against KPIs.

- Produces monthly and quarterly reports with clear “so what / now what” insights.
 - Uses data to forecast growth, identify risks, and adjust strategy accordingly.
 - Defines and reports on **North Star Metrics (NSMs)** that link SEO performance to business outcomes.
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3. Content, E-E-A-T & CRO Integration

- Owns content and conversion strategy — ensuring every page supports visibility, user trust, and business impact.
 - Oversees AI-generated content for accuracy, tone, and intent alignment, applying **E-E-A-T** principles.
 - Incorporates SME quotes or client insights to reinforce topical authority.
 - Designs and executes **CRO strategies** — analyzing user behavior to optimize conversion paths, CTAs, and UX flow.
 - Implements smaller CRO and on-page improvements directly; partners with **Dev** only for major site changes.
 - Connects content and CRO improvements to measurable outcomes (lead quality, conversions, revenue impact).
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4. Technical SEO & Quality Assurance

- Owns technical SEO strategy and implementation for crawlability, indexation, and performance.
 - Conducts regular audits (site structure, Core Web Vitals, metadata, schema, internal linking).
 - Executes or oversees fixes directly; engages **Dev** only for structural updates or redesigns.
 - Uses tools (Screaming Frog, Ahrefs, GA4, GSC) to track health and validate implementations.
 - QA's all technical and CRO updates post-launch and clearly communicates business impact.
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5. Client & Account Management

- Serves as the primary client lead — managing communication, strategy, and relationship health.
- Leads regular check-ins and quarterly business reviews (QBRs), tying SEO outcomes to business results.

- Manages expectations proactively, communicates timelines and priorities clearly, and escalates only when needed.
- Identifies and pitches **consultative growth opportunities** (upsell or cross-sell) when strategically aligned.
- Documents all client communications, deliverables, and insights [tbd location].
- Maintains high client satisfaction and retention through proactive partnership and transparency.

6. Collaboration & Internal Contribution

- Acts as strategic owner across all accounts, managing SEO, CRO, and light technical work independently.
- Engages with **PPC, Sales, or Admissions Ops** only for growth initiatives or multi-channel opportunities.
- Partners with **Dev** for large-scale projects (new builds, redesigns), ensuring SEO and CRO accuracy.
- Shares learnings, SOPs, and case studies to improve team performance and alignment.
- Participates in internal discussions, training, and mentorship to support a strong, collaborative team culture.

Performance Measurement

Performance is evaluated based on progress toward each client's **North Star Metric (NSM)** and the consistency of supporting behaviors that drive those outcomes. This includes strategy execution, communication quality, documentation accuracy, and contribution to team collaboration and improvement.

Category	KPI	Target / Expectation
Client NSMs Steady growth toward client's quarterly or annual NSM target	Defined per client (Organic Sessions, Leads, VOBs, Admits)	
Client Retention	Client renewal rate	90%+ annual retention
Account Health	Response time to client messages	<24 hours

Delivery	On-time reporting and strategy updates	100% consistency
Internal Collaboration	Team communication rating (peer feedback)	≥8/10

Competencies & Skill Framework

This framework defines the core skills, behaviors, and strategic capabilities expected of every SEO Account Manager. It serves as both a guide for daily performance and a roadmap for professional growth. Each competency includes clear behavioral examples and development indicators to help measure progress from foundational to advanced levels.

1. Channel & Technical Expertise

- Demonstrates advanced SEO knowledge across technical, on-page, and content strategy.
- Conducts independent SEO audits identifying both technical and strategic priorities.
- Connects keyword and content opportunities to conversion and patient acquisition journeys.
- Utilizes core tools (Ahrefs, SEMrush, Screaming Frog, GA4, GSC, Looker Studio) effectively for insights and diagnosis.
- Builds content frameworks and internal linking strategies that reinforce topical authority and funnel intent.

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Indicators of Growth:

- **Developing:** Requires oversight to complete audits or apply technical insights.
- **Proficient:** Independently builds SEO strategies aligned with business KPIs.
- **Advanced:** Anticipates technical or content issues before they impact performance; mentors peers. </aside>

2. Strategy & Analytical Thinking

- Builds integrated, goal-driven SEO strategies tied to client business outcomes.

- Defines and tracks **NSMs (North Star Metrics)** that connect SEO performance to conversions, leads, or revenue.
- Uses forecasting to set realistic growth goals and interpret impact.
- Turns data into insights and insights into strategy adjustments.

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Indicators of Growth:

- **Developing:** Relies on templates and reactive thinking.
- **Proficient:** Proactively connects data to business goals and communicates it confidently.
- **Advanced:** Shapes long-term strategy and forecasting models across multiple accounts. </aside>

3. Client & Consultative Skills

- Leads client relationships with ownership, clarity, and composure.
- Sets and resets expectations effectively; uses structured objection handling (“Acknowledge → Clarify → Reframe → Reconfirm”).
- Demonstrates consultative selling — identifies growth opportunities, proposes initiatives, and frames recommendations around ROI.
- Tells cohesive performance stories linking SEO metrics to real-world business impact.

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Indicators of Growth:

- **Developing:** Provides updates but lacks strategic framing or confidence.
- **Proficient:** Consistently communicates insights and handles standard objections.
- **Advanced:** Trusted advisor status; drives strategic alignment and influences client direction. </aside>

4. Project & Account Management

- Plans and manages client campaigns with structure, clarity, and accountability.

- Uses project management systems (Asana, Notion, ClickUp) to organize tasks, dependencies, and timelines.
- Ensures deliverables meet deadlines and quality standards without leadership intervention.
- Communicates proactively about risks, blockers, and outcomes.

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Indicators of Growth:

- **Developing:** Reactive; requires oversight for organization or prioritization.
- **Proficient:** Manages full campaigns independently; maintains visibility and momentum.
- **Advanced:** Improves workflows, mentors peers, and contributes to operational best practices. </aside>

5. Leadership, Team, & Culture

- Models professionalism, curiosity, and proactive communication.
- Contributes positively to team culture — shares learnings, supports peers, and engages constructively in feedback loops.
- Demonstrates cross-department collaboration with PPC and other operational teams when appropriate
- Participates in department development: process improvements, SOPs, or documentation.

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Indicators of Growth:

Developing: Operates independently but not collaboratively; limited initiative.

Proficient: Actively contributes ideas, supports peers, and communicates constructively.

Advanced: Leads by example; drives cross-functional alignment and department improvement.

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6. Growth Mindset & Self-Development

- Stays informed on Google algorithm updates, AI search evolution, and best practices in SEO.
- Actively applies new learnings to client work and shares insights with peers.
- Seeks out feedback, owns growth areas, and demonstrates measurable improvement over time.
- Contributes to team development by sharing case studies, insights, or process improvements.

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Indicators of Growth:

- **Developing:** Consumes information reactively (e.g., reading updates but not applying them). Needs reminders to engage in ongoing learning or share takeaways.
- **Proficient:** Regularly implements new learnings into client strategy; shares insights during team syncs or retros. Demonstrates consistent curiosity and initiative.
- **Advanced:** Anticipates trends and proactively tests or documents new approaches. Leads internal discussions, mentors peers, and contributes to refining team-wide standards or processes. </aside>

Role Level & Growth Path

This role reports to their **SEO Associate Director** and may evolve into:

- **Senior SEO Account Manager** (larger, higher-revenue clients)
- **SEO Associate Director** (team leadership and advanced strategic oversight)